LFH Case No. 186

Black's School District
Trout Brook Ranche May 3 [18]79

Dear Friend Ettie

Again my silence is broken why is it that we keep up such a thinking without allowing one thought expression.

I have been very busy of late, in school, very pleasantly situated good salary with the prospect of an increase in wages next year if I wish to remain at present it is $65 per month board $12 with privileges of doing my own washing. I am just as happy as is possible for a girl to be when separated from that Better half.

She may be married next year; but no time is set. his business being quite uncertain at present; and the paralyzed brother wholly helpless.

I wish you were a teacher and could come out here. I could help you to a situation for I've gained many influential true friends since I came away from my Uncle's immediate neighborhood.

It grinds them to think that I can "paddle my own canoe." I am trying to show them what Jennine independence means, and they begin to appreciate me the more they seek my society the more occupied I become and they begin to think that good for nothing lazy cousin is of some importance after all. I may be wrong; but it does not grieve me to see them humble. I wish I could see you today. Tis one of God's beautiful days the fields are ripening flowers are in blossom and all nature seems to rejoice. I was wondering what improvement could be made in this vicinity of God's universe. I have not told you how I situated. Well, sit with ears redy. I'm about 1/3 of an mile from Olema Station. I just wish you could peep into room tis beautiful and I do not have to share it with anyone; but if you come you may sleep with me or rather rest without sleeping for as I look from my west or North window, the beautiful Trout-brook presents a picture so lovely for discussion [?] for no picture can paint sound, and as the musical brook winds to the mighty sea it sings all the lively thoughtless airs of youth. I live over again my happy girlhood; but do not quite forget that my Brook melody mony ['long'?] since[1] reached the Sea of responsible woman hood, and that ^ while ^ the song of the brook may please me most, I can not choose the dream that most would please me, nor can I be a child

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1 1"mony since" indicates that these words were written above the text.

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until I shall have lived several more years. we must wait for second childhood.

I was wondering whether I had ever sent you a picture or not. I have some but they don't look any more like me than like an Egyptian mummy, so says a friend, but perhaps with straining the imaginative powers to the fullest extent you will be able to recognize provided I label it, your mummy friend.

I have a pleasant home at Cousin Colby Hearvey's when ever I am at leisure to go where they have always a hearty welcome for Emmce Fair as the baby calls me. And another home in Petaluma at Mrs. Shippee's also one at Mr. Nelson Carr's[2] in Bennett Valley and one at Mrs. Barstow's in San Rafael. They all want me to spend vacation with them.

The letter continues on the second page of the letter, in the margin on the left-hand side.

I could write another sheet but time will not allow.

LFH Case No. 186. The letter ends with a "P.S." on the right margin of the second

1 2Nelson Carr was the son of Solomon C. and Debroah Goodrich Carr. (*See: 1884 7 7 Letr. Kittie G. to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, #324*). HON. SOLOMON C. CARR, residing on section 19, in the town of Milton, is one of the honored pioneers of Rock County, and one of the leading citizens not only of the community but of the State. By his work in the Patrons of Husbandry, he has gained a wide reputation, of which he may justly be proud. He was born on the 19th day of December, 1830, in New York, and is a son of Peleg S. and Deborah (GOODRICH) CARR, who were natives of Rensselaer County, N.Y. The father was descended from Scotch ancestry, and the mother was of English origin. Peleg CARR followed the occupation of farming throughout his entire life. He grew to manhood in his native county, and was there joined in wedlock with Miss GOODRICH, who proved a true helpmate to him. In 1839, with the desire to better his financial condition, he resolved to emigrate to the West, where the advantages were superior to those afforded by the older States of the East. Accompanied by his family he reached the Territory of Wisconsin on the 26th day of May, 1839, and the next day bought a claim of 480 acres in Milton Township, Rock County. The land was uncultivated, and except on one acre not a furrow had been turned, and not a fence had been built or an improvement made. He moved into a little log cabin, which became the first home of the family in this county. Underneath its roof they shared the trials and privations incident to frontier life, and witnessed the growth of town and county. Ten children were born to Mr. and Mrs. CARR, six sons and four daughters: Polly A. became the wife of Nathaniel ROSE, and both are now deceased; She was born Jan. 24, 1817; Ezra S., born March 19, 1819, studied medicine and attained to a place of prominence in the ranks of his professional brethren; Nelson lives in California, aged sixty-seven; Emeline was born August 14, 1826, and married Robert POWELL; she is now deceased. John S., born June 18, 1822, died in 1850; Solomon Carpenter was the sixth in order of birth; Eleanor M., born Jan. 26, 1833, is the wife of Henry POWELL, a conductor on the Chicago, Burlington & Quincy Railroad, residing in Chicago; Elijah M., born March 11, 1835, is a prominent fruit-grower residing in San Luis, Obispo Co., Cal.; Sarah C., born November 15, 1836, became the wife of H. W. MAXON, and is now deceased; Joseph G., born March 19, 1840, is represented elsewhere in this work. As the children reached a sufficient age they were afforded good opportunities for securing and education, and were thus fitted for useful and responsible positions in life.

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page.

54 P.S. Please tell me whether you have a picture [if] not I will send one if you have not

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LFH Case No. 186. 3 May 1879 Letter Emma J. Thayer, Black's School District, Trout Brook Ranche, Olema Station, Marin Co., California To Juliaette A. E. Flagler, Monticello, Green Co., Wisconsin. Data: env.; no return address; $ .03 green stamp "G.W."; front postmark, "Duncans Mills[3] CA May 8" and "Milton, May 12, WIS"; no back postmark; 5 x 8 in; not embossed; no letterhead; no watermark; postscript; Wotim; blue-lined paper; 1 letter sheet; cursive; black ink; cotton-fibre; doc. cond. good; legibility fair; 1 date, 1 author; formal heading, per. formal greeting, no complimentary close & no sig. line; written Saturday. This letter is written by the same woman who wrote the 8 September 1876 letter to Juliaette discussing her transcontinental railroad journey to Sonoma County, California. The letter begins with an interesting comment on epistolary practices as she states: "Again my silence is broken why is it that we keep up such a thinking without allowing one thought expression." She then describes her present circumstances at the school she teaches, telling Ettie that she $65 a month and $12 for boarding with washing privileges. She then states "I am just as happy as is possible for a girl to be when separated from that Better half." Meaning, perhaps a breakup with a possible suitor as she refers to her self in the third person on line 14: "She may be married next year; but no time is set. his business being quite uncertain at present; and the paralyzed brother wholly helpless." She then tells Ettie that she wished she (Ettie) was a teacher because she has gained "many influential true friends" and could help her obtain a situation "since I came away from my Uncle's immediate neighborhood." In her fifth paragraph Ettie's friend begins an extraordinary declaration of independence stating, "It grinds them to think that I can "paddle my own canoe." I am trying to show them what Jennine independence means, and they begin to appreciate me the more they seek my society the more occupied I become and they begin to think that good for nothing lazy cousin is of some importance after all." Ettie's friend then tells Ettie that "it does not grieve me to see them humble. I wish I could see you today." In line 25 she informs Juliaette that it is a lovely day and then begins to tell her how she is situated: "I'm about 1/3 of an mile from Olema Station. I just wish you could peep into room tis beautiful and I do not have to share it with anyone." She goes onto say that looking from her north or west window she has a beautiful "Trout-brook" (no doubt Olema Creek) which presents "a picture so lovely for discussion [?] for no picture can paint sound, and as the musical brook winds to the mighty sea it sings all the lively thoughtless airs of youth." Ettie's friend's hyperbole however, is tempered with her realization that her "Brook melody" has reached the "Sea of responsible woman hood." In the sixth paragraph Ettie's friend returns to more mundane vistas asking if Ettie received a picture of her even though "they don't look any more like me than like an Egyptian mummy." In the seventh paragraph she states she has a pleasant home at Cousin Colby Hearvey's where the baby calls her "Emmce Fair" and then relates a whole series of homes situated in Marin County: "…another home in Petaluma at Mrs. Shippee's also one at Mr. Nelson Carr's in Bennett Valley and one at Mrs. Barstow's in San Rafael." Ettie's friend ends her letter saying she doesn't have time to write another sheet, and asks if Ettie has received a picture of her or not. Note: In researching the Thayer Family genealogy I came across a reference to Emma Jane Thayer in the 1880 U.S. Census for Bolinas, Marin Co., California. In the 1880 census report Emma's birth is "about 1853" in Wisconsin and her mother and father's birthplace is Maine" which correlates with the 1860 & 1870 U.S. Census for Janesville, Rock Co., Wis. In the 1880 U.S.

1 3Duncans Mills, Sonoma County, was named for S.M. And A. Duncan, who built a mill there in 1860. The post office was established on 20 Dec. 1862. Gudde, Erwin G. *California Place Names: The Origin and Etymology of Current Geographical Names.* 4th Ed. Revised by William Bright; University of California Press, 1998.

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LFH Case No. 186. Census for Bolinas, Marin Co., her occupation is listed as "School teacher." Both the Flagler and Thayer families appear on the same page in the 1860 and 1870 census reports for Janesville, Emma being 18 and Juliette 16. Similarly, in the Wisconsin Marriage records 1820-2004, Emma Jane Thayer married Josiah Robert Morrow on 15 Jan. 1881 in Janesville, Wisconsin. See: Emma J. Thayer wrote eight letters to Juliette A. E. Flagler: *1872 4 9 Letr. Emma Thayer to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 061*; *1873 12 3 Letr. Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 62*; *1874 9 16 Letter - 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A. E. Flagler, 078*; *1875 2 22 Letr. Emma J. Thayer 'E.J.F.' to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 095*; *1875 3 14 Letr. 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 099*; and *1874 9 20 - Letter Emma Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 536*; *1876 9 8 Letter Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 132*; and *1879 5 3 Letter - Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 186*.

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